

EDUCATION

Sabancı University , Istanbul, Turkey	
BSc Computer Science and Engineering	<i>Graduated June 2025</i>
CGPA: 3.56/4.0	
50% Merit Scholarship	
BSc Double Major in Industrial Engineering	<i>Expected Graduation June 2026</i>
Uskudar American Academy , Istanbul, Turkey	<i>Graduated June 2021</i>
High School - GPA: 88.5/100	

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

VRL Lab, Sabancı University , Istanbul, Turkey	<i>Feb. 2024 - Present</i>
- Developed a large scale multimodal, image and text, dataset from scratch by scraping 250+ websites, resulting in a dataset with over 1.19M images and 1.17M articles - Dataset paper is published at <i>Nature Scientific Data</i>, the project website is available at www.globaldiplomacy.net - Took responsibility of the development of the dataset including the collection, quality control, processing and reproducible dissemination - Designed natural language processing pipelines for extracting diplomatic interaction networks from textual data, utilizing named entities, and carrying out subsequent tasks such as entity linking/disambiguation	

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Learning Assistant - Sabancı University	
CS301: Algorithms	<i>Jan. - May 2025</i>
CS210: Introduction to Data Science	<i>Sept. - Dec. 2024</i>
CS303: Logic and Digital System Design	<i>Oct. 2023 - Jan. 2024</i>
I held weekly office hours, recitation and lab sections, graded homework/projects and mentored students with term projects	

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Data Science Intern - Mars Athletic , Istanbul, Turkey	<i>June - Sept. 2025</i>
- Developed a churn prediction model for newly acquired customers to identify those at risk of churn - Helped develop a customer segmentation model for online users based on engagement metrics using an RFM inspired approach	
Data Science and Analytics Intern - PwC Turkey , Istanbul, Turkey	<i>June - Nov. 2024</i>
- Implemented automated and efficient data cleaning and processing pipelines, improving performance by 10× through a reusable framework adaptable to a wide range of customers - Developed an internal machine learning system to help speed up the hiring process	

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Articles	
Muğurtay, N., Şirin, K.G., Heshmat Najafabad, M. et al. Quantifying Global Foreign Affairs with a Multimodal Dataset of Diplomatic Websites. <i>Sci Data</i> (2025). doi.org/10.1038/s41597-025-06334-5 	

SELECTED
COURSE
PROJECTS

Analyzing the Turkish Political Scene in Wikipedia

2024

- Constructed a social network from Wikipedia entries of Turkish political figures, to detect and analyze communities, and shifts through time and significant political events
- Analyzed editor-article networks to reveal biases and patterns in the edited articles

Predicting Homework Grades From ChatGPT

2023

- Predicted what grade students got on their homeworks using their ChatGPT conversations as features
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SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, SQL, C++, Shell

Frameworks and Libraries: Polars, Matplotlib, Seaborn, Numpy, Spacy, Scikit Learn, Transformers, PyTorch, Ollama, Streamlit

Languages: Turkish (Native), English (Proficient)

HOBBIES AND
ACTIVITIES

Hobbies: Painting, Pottery and Photography

Activities: Served as a Board Member at Sabancı University *Artelier Fine Arts Club* where I helped organize weekly workshops, classes and other activities